

3.5 Crime and deviance

3.5.1 The social construction of crime and deviance

Content	Additional information
• The social construction of concepts of crime and deviance and explanations of crime and deviance. • The work of Merton on the causes of crime from a functionalist perspective and Becker from an interactionist perspective.	Students should be able to: • identify, describe and explain various sociological explanations of crime and deviance including anomie, labelling, structural theories, subcultural theories and interactionist theory • explain the social construction of concepts of crime and deviance • describe, compare and contrast a variety of sociological perspectives on the social construction of crime and deviance (interactionist, functionalist, feminist and Marxist) • describe the key ideas of Merton (page 50) on the causes of crime • describe the key ideas of Becker (page 48) on the causes of crime.